Husk

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/46673386.

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by NeurodivergentCatra

Summary

Catra struggles with the knowledge of Adora's resurrection and murder of Hordak; Shadow Weaver grooms the zombie

Zombie

"Good job, Adora." Shadow Weaver praised, overlooking the scene in front of her. Her bloodthirsty apprentice had ripped Hordak apart, and there was blood everywhere. Blood dripped from her lips, and her pointed teeth. It growled slightly and nodded, and then went back to tearing up the carcass that was Hordak. A guard walked in, vomited up his lunch, and ran. "Great, now the whole Fright Zone will be aware of this." Shadow Weaver muttered.

She sat on the Throne, and waited for the Force Captains and Generals to arrive. All but Scorpia eventually made their way to the throne room. "What makes you think you deserve that throne?" Grizzlor howled.

"Why, I was Hordak's second-in-command before his *unfortunate* passing." Shadow Weaver drawled sarcastically.

"Why did you kill Lord Hordak?" he questioned.

"Because he was a fool. He never saw the true path to our victory, but I did." She replied. "However, if you still wish to question my rule, Adora would love to hear it."

Grizzlor looked at Adora, blood still dripping from her lips, the hollow expression behind her eyes. "Yes, Lord Weaver." He conceded, falling to one knee and bowing his head. The others followed suit.

/////

“Catra, wake up!” Bow called. Catra stirred awake.

“Huh? What’s going on?” Catra asked.

“You fainted after your friends from the Horde came to Bright Moon.”

“I don’t have friends in the Horde, my only friends are you and Glimmer.” Catra responded, getting to her feet.

“More so, after what they told us about Adora.” Bow continued. It all came back to Catra at that moment. Shadow Weaver had raised Adora from the dead and used her to kill Hordak. Catra was a wreck, understandably. The love of her life, once dead and now under Weaver’s control again.

“Where are they?”

“Getting situated. Their rooms are downstairs.” Bow answered.

“I want to speak with them again.” Catra stated. So, they walked downstairs. Bow felt a heavy worrying feeling about the look on Catra’s face. She knocked on the door Bow led her to, and Lonnie, Kyle, and Rogelio were behind it.

“Oh, hey Catra.” Kyle greeted.

“What did you mean when you said she looked like Adora but wasn’t?” Catra asked.

“Straight to the point, I guess.” Kyle muttered. “She has Adora’s face, but her hair is black and flowy like Weaver’s. Her eyes are emotionless and grayed out. She responds to the name Adora, but she doesn’t speak.”

“Why do you care so much?” Lonnie interrupted.

“Because, as if it wasn’t obvious, I loved her. That’s why we ran away together!” Catra hissed. Lonnie’s eyes widened.

“Called it!” Kyle announced.

“So… now what?” Lonnie asked.

“Now, we figure out what Weaver’s up to, and whether that thing is really Adora.” Catra replied. “Bow, you up for a stealth mission?”

/////

Catra and Bow hid in the Woods, watching from the trees as a Horde convoy traveled underneath them. They were heading for Thaymor, again. “We always take back Thaymor, I don’t know why it’s so important to them!” Bow whispered.

“I don’t know why Hordak wanted it so bad, but I know why Weaver wants it. Thaymor was going to be Adora’s first mission. I’m willing to bet this is the zombie’s first mission too. Come on.” She whispered back. They raced across the treetops, following the tanks. However, the tanks and foot soldiers stopped before reaching Thaymor. Someone in a black hooded cloak stepped out of one of the tanks, and headed for the village alone. Catra noticed that any shadows within a few feet of her became distorted. They followed her to the village of Thaymor. Not many people lived here anymore, after so many Horde attacks. Most of them moved deeper into the Woods or up North. The plaza was empty when the hooded person arrived. She moved her fingers around in a circle, and the shadows around her swirled into the air, covering the town in darkness. It was a trick Catra had witnessed Shadow Weaver do once, but this hooded figure was too small to be the wretched bitch.

The tanks used the shadows in the sky as a signal and stormed the town. A family with goat-like horns ran from their house in an effort to reach the safety of the dense forest, but Shadow Weaver’s signature black lightning shot from the hooded figure’s fingers, knocking them out immediately. The figure began

laughing wickedly, and Catra froze. She could hear Adora's laugh underneath. "Oh, no." she muttered.

Bow shot a grappling arrow at a tree across the clearing, and swooped in to save the goat family. Catra ran and tackled the hooded figure. When it looked back at her, she saw the woman Kyle was talking about. Her skin was far too pale, her hair was deep, shadowy black, but her eyes flashed blue for a split second when she caught sight of Catra. "Adora, are you in there?" Catra shouted. A horde soldier came up behind Catra with a stun baton, but Catra quickly dodged out of the way. Unfortunately, that means the stun baton hit Adora. Adora stood, and the soldier cowered in fear.

"I'm so sorry, Captain. It won't happen again!" the soldier cried.

The zombie said nothing, just shocked the soldier with her black lightning, and then turned back to Catra. It inched closer, and when it snarled Catra noticed it sported sharp new fangs that were stained with blood. When it finally opened its mouth, Catra's nose was overwhelmed by the scents of blood and death. She also noticed that there was now a heartbeat. Slower than Adora's had been when she was alive, but picking up speed. She began to back away from Adora as she crept closer.

"Adora, please, say something!" Catra wailed. Bow had just returned after getting the innocents to safety, and stood behind Catra. The horde soldiers nervously looked on at the two women, refusing to budge an inch until a new order was given. "You aren't Adora, are you?"

Adora giggled. “Why, of course I am.” the figure stated, but it was Shadow Weaver’s voice, not Adora’s. “Why don’t you come over here, and talk to me, my love?”

“Weaver.” Catra muttered.

“Ah well, guess we do this the hard way.” Weaver replied. Adora’s hand shot up, and Catra tackled Bow out of the way of the lightning blast. “Get them.” Weaver ordered, and the tanks began to move again. Catra and Bow ran into the densest trees they could find and kept running through the Woods until they couldn’t hear Horde machinery any longer.

“So, Catra, you wanna talk about that?” Bow asked.

“That’s not Adora.”

“Do you want to go to Mystacor and see what we can find? Maybe there’s a way to break Weaver’s spell!”

“Worth a shot.” Catra mumbled.

Recovery

Chapter Summary

Catra and Bow go to Mystacor; Glimmer wakes up

"Casta!" Catra shouted.

"Catra, Bow, what are you doing here?" Casta asked.

"We were hoping you have books on resurrection." Bow explained.

"No. That is forbidden magic, and has been locked away for a long time."

"Maybe you can still help us? Shadow Weaver brought Adora back, but she looks like a monster and is under Shadow Weaver's full control." Bow continued.

"She *has* broken every other rule of magic, why am I surprised when she does things like this?" Casta muttered. "Theoretically, bringing someone back to life, as some sort of monster or otherwise, should drag the soul back as well. It sounds like Weaver has some sort of mind control spell on her as well."

"Wait, you're telling me Adora is in there, but can't do anything about it!?" Catra screamed.

" *Theoretically* , yes. Unfortunately, I don't know how to perform or reverse either of those spells. I have more bad news, though. If you break the mind control spell, there's a chance it will also reverse the resurrection spell, especially if Shadow Weaver is using her life force for both of these spells. And from what Angella told me about the other Horde defectors' testimony, it sounds like that's the case. I'm sorry, Catra." Castaspella explained. Catra crumpled to the ground, tears flowing from her eyes.

Bow dropped down and wrapped his arm around Catra. "Hey, it's gonna be okay, Catra. We'll figure this out together. In the meantime, since we're here, maybe you and Casta can train your magic abilities! Maybe you'll even be able to best Glimmer after she recovers!" Bow stated.

"That's a great idea, Bow!" Casta exclaimed. "I'll get the practice room ready!"

/////

"Ow." Glimmer murmured as she woke up.

"Glimmer!" her mother exclaimed, immediately hugging her.

"Mom?"

“I’m here, Glimmer.”

“I’m so sorry. I should have listened to you…” Glimmer muttered.

“No, I’m the one to be sorry. I shouldn’t have been so hard on you. I just… I don’t want to lose you too.” the Queen sighed.

“You won’t.” Glimmer replied. The queen smiled softly and they sat there in silence for a moment. “Where are Catra and Bow?”

“They… they snuck out of the castle not too long ago. The Horde defectors mentioned something about Adora?”

“Horde defectors? Adora? How long have I been out!?” Glimmer shrieked.

“A couple days. Catra’s friends from the Horde, the ones that you fought in Salineas according to Mermista, are now in Brightmoon. They requested asylum, and Catra and Bow vouched for them. As for Adora…”

“I told Shadow Weaver where to find the body…” Glimmer murmured.

/////

Bow shot an arrow at Catra, who rolled out of the way and shot a fireball back at him. Usually, this was a pretty standard move she had practiced many times with Glimmer. With Bow, he was in a bit more actual danger without the ability to teleport. He shot his grappling hook arrow into a nearby wall, and sent himself flying out of the way. He turned to find Catra staring at him. He shot an arrow, which went straight through and landed on the ground. Suddenly, Catra's furry paws grabbed Bow from behind and disarmed him. "How!?" Bow asked as the illusion of Catra faded away, leaving only him and the real Catra in the room.

"It's a trick Shadow Weaver used to use. Once I started training with magic, it wasn't too hard to figure out how she did it." Catra explained, handing the bow back to its rightful owner.

"Shadow Weaver!?"

"She's using Adora against me, I think I'm well within my rights to use her magic against her! Especially when it's not even dark magic!" Catra responded.

"Still…" Bow murmured.

Suddenly, the two were interrupted by Castaspella bursting through the doors. "Glimmer is awake!"

The End

Chapter Summary

> Bow goes back to Brightmoon for Glimmer. Catra has her own plans.

Chapter Notes

> I may or may not have gotten so focused on a newer story that I completely forgot about this one. This is what I had written down for the last chapter, edited slightly as to skip over a chapter or two I would've had in the middle. It's not a happy ending, either. Which is also probably part of the reason it took me so long to get back to.

Bow shuffled into Glimmer's room. She was still recovering from the damage Shadow Weaver had done, and didn't move, but she still smiled. "Hey, Bow. How's it goin?"

"Oh, Glimmer, I'm so glad you're okay!"

"Chill out, worrywart. Shadow Bitch ain't got nothin on me."

"You… are you sure you're okay? You have even less of a filter than usual." Bow noticed immediately.

"Yeah, I'm great. Mom's doctors gave me something for the pain, and I don't feel a thing!"

Angella appeared behind Bow, evidently even better at sneaking than he was. “She’s referring to painkillers, which are also affecting her mind. She’s going to be… out of it, for a while.” Angella whispered, laying a hand on Bow’s shoulder. “I appreciate you being here for her.” After a brief moment of silence, she added, “Where’s Catra?”

Bow tensed up immediately. “She… uh… She went searching for Adora. Again.” He explained, unable to think of a lie.

“Oh. That poor girl. I could only imagine what it would be like to see Micah walking around without control of his own body.” Angella muttered.

“You’re not mad?”

“How could I be? She’s just like Glimmer, so stubborn and focused on ideals. I’ve grown to care about her as I do Glimmer, but I also know that if I were in her shoes…”

“You’d be doing the same thing.” Bow concluded. The queen nodded.

/////

Catra watched from above as yet another Horde convoy knocked its way through the trees. Still no zombie in sight. She’d have to

wait for the next one. As soon as she was sure the tree she was in wasn't going to be cut down by the Horde soldiers, she relaxed on the branch she was perched on, and began thinking about a very difficult thought. If she were to find Adora, what would she even do? That thing wasn't exactly Adora, but it wasn't not Adora either. It didn't look or sound like her, but it also did in certain ways. And what if Adora actually was trapped in there? If Aunt Casta didn't know how to break the spell, who would? Shadow Weaver would. Although, Shadow Weaver would never reverse the spell without stealing the life force back that she had put into the corpse. Yet, that seemed a preferable outcome to Adora being forced to roam Etheria and commit crimes she had always wanted to get away from. Unable to control her own body as she looted, slaughtered, and more. Catra got the shivers just thinking about this. Another Horde convoy made noise in the distance. Two convoys in ten minutes could only mean they were after a nearby village. The closest village was Thaymor. Again. They were trying to take it for a fourth, maybe even a fifth time, Catra concluded. A large vehicle followed this convoy, and perched on the viewing deck was the Corpse.

Catra dropped down onto the platform silently, not alerting anyone but the corpse to her arrival. It turned and looked at her. "Catra?" it asked. For once, this was not Shadow Weaver's voice. Not even a hint of it. Not a hint of anyone else she had killed either. Her eyes had a slight shade of blue to them, too.

"Adora?"

"Look, I don't know how much longer I'll have control. Two things: I love you, and… I want you to kill me. Again. I'm tired, and I want to go back to the other place. Please, Catra? I'll see

you there when you…" The voice trailed off, and the blue glint in her eyes died. Then, Shadow Weaver's laugh broke the silence.

"I'm pleasantly surprised. I always knew that Adora was something special, but I did *not* expect her to break the spell, even temporarily." Shadow Weaver stated. Adora's body reluctantly followed the motions of Shadow Weaver as she spoke. Catra began to cry. Her tears burned as they fell. "What are you going to do, Catra? You couldn't…" Shadow Weaver was cut off as a huge fireball grew in Catra's hands.

"Adora isn't the only one you've underestimated, Weaver. I wish you the worst." Catra hissed. She released the fire magic quickly, and before any of the Horde could react, the explosion of the large Horde vehicle rocked the forest.

/////

Shadow Weaver's consciousness floated back into her own body. She felt sick after possessing the dead body, but now that it was dead again it felt worse than usual. Shadow Weaver vomited, and then rolled off of the throne. Commander Cobalt marched into the room. Upon seeing Weaver on the ground, so fragile and already sick, without a guard, he smiled. He grabbed his sword, and slowly stomped over. "I've been waiting for a chance like this. You're finished, Weaver." With a single swing, he put her out of her misery. The Horde was set to implode, but Cobalt didn't care much. He would take the downfall of the Horde during the battle for control instead of it being run by the most vile woman to ever exist. He dropped the sword, and exited the building.

/////

Angella woke up on the floor of Glimmer's room. Bow was sleeping on the sofa, and Glimmer was knocked out in bed. She somewhat remembered offering Bow the sofa and then resting her back against the wall, and drifting off to sleep herself.

The morning sunlight was just starting to fill the bedroom. Angella slowly got up, stretched her uncomfortable back, and snuck away towards her room to grab a cup of coffee. Before she made it back to her room, she was stopped by three guards. "Your Majesty…"

"What is it?"

"Catra is dead."

" *What!?* "

"She went after the Horde, and there was an explosion. We've counted a total of 93 Horde casualties, as well."

"I need coffee, and then we can talk about the details." The queen sighed. This was going to be a long, hard conversation. Not to mention the longer, harder conversation she was going to have to have with Bow and Glimmer.

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